

Michael Raba, MSc Mechanical Engineering

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Featured Projects

Projects

- **1. Multichamber Muffler Design** (2023). Designed a multichamber muffler system with internal components including chambers, baffles, perforates, and fiberglass absorbents. Simulated acoustic performance using industry-standard tools and validated results against measured data.
 - **Tools Used:** ANSYS 2023 (Acoustics Module), SIDLAB 5.1, (Verification of Model using 1d approximation)
 - Modeled transmission and insertion loss across 0–1000 Hz using fluid approximations
 - Created CAD-style schematics and component breakdowns for internal geometry
 - Compared simulated and measured acoustic data using Transmission Loss (TL) and Insertion Loss (IL) metrics
 - Published downloadable simulation files for reproducibility and benchmarking
- **2. Viscoplastic Modeling** (2023). Applied Anand's viscoplasticity model to simulate strain-rate and temperature-dependent behavior of solder alloys on microchip package. Forward Euler integration scheme in Python to solve constitutive equations and model stress evolution under thermal effects to verify Ansys model.
 - **Tools Used:** ANSYS (nonlinear materials module), Python NumPy (Verification using Numerical Model)
 - **Material parameter fitting** based on experimental data
- **3. Electromagnetics Simulation: Finite Difference Time Domain — Navier Stokes Simulation** (2019). Calculates in 3D space location of a particle in a **magnetized fluid flow** using the Yee Scheme, using finite difference equations and staggered time-stepping.
- **4. MSc Project – POD Analysis of Turbulent Pipe Flow** (2023). Developed a MATLAB-based framework to analyze turbulent rotating pipe flow using Proper Orthogonal Decomposition (POD). Compared Classic and Snapshot POD methods to extract dominant energetic structures and reconstruct flow fields.
 - **Tools Used:** MATLAB, Python, C++, fortran2020, linux
 - Models produces simplified model from 5 Terabytes of data to enable better design decisions

Employment

Research Assistant	University of Kentucky	2020 – 2023
• Collaboration with 11 PhD students at University of Maryland, College Park and University of Oxford • Attended AIAA Aviation and Aeronautics Forum in Chicago, IL (2022)		
Teaching Assistant	University of Kentucky	Fall 2020 & Spring 2023
• TA for course on Design of Experiments (DOE), (ME311 Experimental Design II), a senior level course covering Heat Transfer, Fluid Mechanics, Statics, Engineering Statistics and R; also taught ME 330 Fluid Mechanics I as an undergraduate and ME 321 Thermodynamics II as recitation leader in Fall 2020.		
Wayfinding Assistant	Chandler Medical Center	Fall 2019 – Spring 2020 and July 2023 – Present
• Developed custom wayfinding map app to assist hospital visitors. Flask, Python, SQL		

Education

Lexington, KY	University of Kentucky	Fall 2015 – December 2023
• BA in Mathematics, May 2019. In-major GPA: 3.6. • MSc in Mechanical Engineering, December 2025 (Expected). GPA: 3.3		